

Element K: Reflection on the Design Project

We began the project by researching everything about rain gardens, the best places for them, what types of plants should be used (especially DC native ones), how they should be designed, and experts near us we could talk to. We then started reaching out to experts and considering where the best place for our rain garden would be. Once we decided that the plots in front of the school were the best location, and found plants that worked, we were able to communicate with experts more, explaining the plan we had and asking them questions on how to improve. We have now met with them multiple times, and they will present their final ideas on how to help us this coming week, and then we will finally build our rain garden. Although we had our struggles and setbacks, including having to restrict the types of plants we were going to use for a little while, struggles with finding the right experts, and our entire group not being able to meet with experts during school times. Halfway through the process, we discovered that since our school is built on historic or government ground, we could only have all green plants that are 3ft tall max, but with the help of management at the school, we were able to continue with the project and not change the plants we were planning to use. At the beginning of finding experts, we also struggled. We looked through professors at colleges and other academic circles and reached out to some people, but some people didn't respond. When we finally found someone, they told us that they were not able to meet due to personal conflicts, but were able to connect us with another professor, leading us to the experts we have connected with now. Throughout this project, we were able to learn how to work together more and even how to work with experts outside of our normal circles. We were able to learn good planning skills and how to communicate with others to progress our project.